B

b it-tieni ittra ta' l-alfabett Malti.

b' titqiegħed flok **bi**; tieħu għamliet oħra meta tingħaqad ma' l-artiklu, bħal **bil-**, eċċ. jew meta tingħaqad mal-pronom, bħal **bih**; **biha**, eċċ. u tfisser – **with; at; by; of** etc. Araw dawn l-eżempji:- **b'id soda**, with a steady hand; **b'nofs prezz**, at half price; **rajtu b'għajnejja**, I saw him with my own eyes; **bi ftit flus**, with little money; **bil-għajnuna tagħkom**, with your help; **bil-kappell f'rasu**, with his hat on his head; **miet bil-ġuħ**, he died of hunger; **kiteb bil-lapes**, to write in pencil; **bid-dawl tax-xama'**, by candlelight; **daħak bih (biha)**, he made a fool of him (her).

babbu a simpleton; a blockhead; a stupid person.

babel babel; confusion; disorder.

baċir basin; wash-basin, shipyard; dock; a place for building and repairing ships.

badissa (is-superjura f'abbatija) abbess.

baga buoy.

bagoll trunk.

bagħal (annimal) mule.

bagħal (bniedem) bastard; illegitimate.

bagħat, *jibgħat* to send, to despatch; to dismiss; **bagħat għat-tabib**, he sent for the doctor.

bagħbas, *jbagħbas* to finger; to handle; to feel; to touch repeatedly here and there.

bagħda hatred; aversion; hostility; antipathy.

baħar sea; **baħar bnazzi**, calm, smooth sea; **baħar qawwi**, rough sea; **żiffa tal-baħar**, sea-breeze; **bil-baħar u bl-art**, by sea and by land; **ħass ħażin tal-baħar**, sea-sickness.

baħbaħ, *jbaħbaħ* to rinse; to wash lightly.

baħbuħa sea-shell.

baħħ empty; emptiness; void; solitude.

baħnan stupid; dull; simpleton.

baħri sailor; able-seaman; **dak baħri fix-xogħol tiegħu**, he is clever at his work.

baħrija hornet.

bajd eggs; **bajda**, an egg; **bajd frisk**, new-laid eggs; **bajd iebes**, hard-boiled eggs; **bajd mgħolli**, boiled eggs; **bajd moqli**, fried eggs.

bajd (glandoli fir-raġel) testicles.

bajda (kulur) white; **bajdani**, whitish.

bajja bay.

bajjad, *jbajjad* to whiten; to whitewash; **bajjâd** (minn bajjad), a whitewasher.

bajsikil bicycle.

bajtar tax-xewk prickly pears.

bajtra fig; (*fig.*) slow; soft; lazy; tardy.

bajunetta bayonet.

bakkaljaw cod.

bakkar, *jbakkar* to rise early; **bakkari**, an early riser.

bala',. *jibla'* to swallow; to gulp down; to gobble.

balalu a simpleton; an imbecile; stupid; dull.

balavostri balustrade.

baldakkin canopy.
baliena whale.
balla ball; shell; **balla ta' kanun**, cannon ball.
ballerin, ballerina dancer.
ballett ballet.
ballottra weasel.
ballu ball; dancing; **sala tal-ballu, taż-żfin**, dancing-hall.
ballun ball; baloon.
balluta oak.
balzmu balm.
Bambin (il-) the Infant Jesus.
bamboċċ a simpleton.
bambù bamboo.
banali banal; common-place; trivial; trite.
banana banana.
banda (naħa) side; **minn banda għal oħra**, from one side to the other; **minn kull banda, naħa**, from all sides; **miż-żewġ bnadi**, from both sides; **band'oħra**, somewhere else.
banda (tad-daqq) band.
bandal, *jbandal* to swing.
bandiera flag.
bandist bandsman.
bandla a swing.
banju bath; bathtub; **ħa banju**, to take a bath; **banju tax-xemx**, sun bath.
bank bench; **bank ta' ħanut**, counter; **bank fejn jitqiegħdu il-flus**, bank.
bankett banquet.
banketta a stool.
bankier banker.
bankina pavement.
baqa', *jibqa'* to remain; to stay.
baqbiqa an outburst of anger or bad temper; **ħa tbaqbiqa**, to fly into a passion; **baqbiqa ta' l-ilma**, a pitcher.
baqqa a bug.
baqqun a pick-axe.
baqqunier stone-cutter; a digger.
baqra cow.
baqta curd.
baram, *jobrom* to twist; to wring with force.
barax, *jobrox* to scratch; to scrape; to grate.
barbaġann an owl.
barbier barber.
bard cold; **bard illum**, it's cold today; **terter bil-bard**, to tremble, to shiver with cold; **qed tħoss il-bard?**, are you feeling cold?
barka benediction; blessing.
barklor boatman.
barkun a lighter; a flat-bottomed boat used for unloading ships; a barge; pontoon.
barma a twist.
barmil bucket; pail.
barnuż cowl; a monk's hood.
barokk baroque.
barometru barometer.
barra out; outside; externally; in the open air; **barra mill-bieb**, outside the door; **fuq barra**, on the outside; **qiegħed barra**, he is out; **barra minn dan**, besides; moreover; **barra mit-triq it-tajba**, astray; off the right path.
barra (mill-pajjiż) abroad; **ġie lura minn barra**, to come back from abroad.
barrakka hut; shed.
barrani foreign; strange; alien; foreigner; stranger; **lsien barrani**, a foreign tongue.
barraxa scraper.
barri bull.
barriera quarry.
barumbara pigeon-hole.
baruni baron; **barunissa**, baroness.
barxa a scratch.
barżakka knapsack, haversack.
basar, *jobsor* to predict; to foretell; to prophesy.
basla an onion; **basla tal-fjuri, ħxejjex**, eċċ., a bulb.
basra prediction; presage; prophecy.
bassa (vulgari) a fart.
bastard bastard; illegitimate.

bastiment ship; vessel; **bastiment tal-gwerra**, a warship.

bastun stick; staff; cudgel; walking stick.

bata, *jbati* to suffer; to bear; to endure.

bati slow; **bati bati**, very slowly; **nar bati**, a slow fire.

batta, *jbatti* to conquer; to overcome; to beat; to abate (make or become less); **ir-riħ qed ibatti**, the wind is abating.

battal, *jbattal* to empty, to vacate; to make vacant.

battâl empty; emptiness; vacant.

battalja battle; fight; combat; **maqtul fil-battalja**, killed in action.

battaljun battalion.

battall knocker; a door-knocker.

batterija battery.

batut poor; needy; miserable; depressed; mortified; **kien batut, bla sold**, to be poor; without a penny.

bavalor a bib.

bavru lapel.

bawxata a picnic; a crime; **iltqajna u għamilna bawxata**, we met and had a picnic, a good time; **għamel bawxata kerha**, he committed a serious crime.

baxx low; shallow; (*fig.*) ignoble; vile; base; **b'leħen baxx**, in a low voice; **ilma, baħar baxx (mhux fond)**, shallow water; **ta' nisel baxx**, of low birth; **għamil baxx, vili**, an ignoble, vile act.

baxx a man or instrument that has deep, low notes.

baxxa, *jbaxxi* to lower; to pull down; to let down; to stoop; (*fig.*) to vilify; to belittle; **baxxa rasu**, to lower one's head.

baxx baxx (bil-moħbi) secretly; stealthily; underhand; furtively.

baża', *jibża'* to fear; to dread; to be afraid.

bażar bazaar; a market place; a fancy shop.

bażi base; foundation; **il-bażi tal-monument**, the base of the monument.

bażwa hernia; rupture.

bażża', *ibażża'* to frighten; to intimidate; to terrify.

bċejjeċ (ara **biċċiet**).

bdiewa (*pl.* ta' **bidwi**).

bdil change; alteration; commutation.

bdot pilot.

bebbuxa snail.

bebbuxi ash-coloured; **qattus bebbuxi**, a tortoise shell cat; (f.) tabby cat.

beċċun pigeon.

beda, *jibda* to start; to begin; to commence.

bejgħ sale; **għall-bejgħ**, for sale.

bejjet to nest; to build a nest.

bejjiegħ a seller; salesman; **bejjiegħ fit-toroq**, a hawker; a pedlar; **bejjiegħ il-fjuri**, a florist; **bejjiegħ il-ħaxix**, a greengrocer; **bejjiegħ il-ħut**, a fishmonger; **bejjiegħ il-laħam**, a butcher.

bejken bacon.

bejn (fost, qalb) between; among; amid; **bejn il-ħamsa u s-sitta**, between five and six; **bejn tas-Sliema u l-Belt**, between Sliema and Valletta; **bejnek u bejni**, between you and me; **wieħed fost ħafna**, one among many; **fost ħwejjeġ oħra**, among other things; **bejnietna**, between us; among us; amongst ourselves; **xtrajnieha bejnietna**, we bought it between us; **għandna £M5 bejnietna**, we have £M5 among us; **bejn ħaltejn** (fid-dubju) doubtful; dubious; uncertain; **bejn wieħed u ieħor**, nearly; about; on an average.

bejt roof.

bejta nest; **bejta tal-fniek**, burrow; **bejta tan-naħal**, bee-hive; **bejta tan-nemel**, ant-hill.

beka, *jibki* to weep; to cry; to shed tears.

bekkej a weeper; one who weeps.
bekkejja (pjanta) weeping willow.
belgħa (boqqa) sip; **belgħa nbid minn tiegħek**, a sip of your wine.
belha (babba) a silly girl; a foolish girl; one without malice.
belhieni foolish; dull; a simpleton.
belladonna Alexandrian Laurel.
belleh, *jbelleh* to bewilder; to amaze; to confound; to astonish.
bellus velvet.
belt town; city; **belti** (ċittadin), a citizen, a townsman.
bena, *jibni* to build; to construct; to erect.
benefattur benefactor.
benefizzju beneficiary.
benġel, *jbenġel* to bruise; to contuse.
benna (minn **bnin**) to taste; to relish; to savour.
bennej mason; builder.
bennen, *jbennen* to rock; to cradle.
benniena a cradle; a cot.
beraħ wide open; **fil-beraħ**, in the open; in the open air, publicly.
beraq (*pl.* ta' **berqa**).
berbaq, *jberbaq* to squander; to waste; to consume; to dissipate.
berbieq (ħali) a spendthrift; a prodigal.
berfel, *jberfel* to hem; to make a hem.
berġa (spiżerija tal-gvern) public dispensary; auberge.
bergħud flea.
berqa lightning; **leħħa ta' berqa**, a flash of lightning; **b'ħeffa ta' berqa**, with lightning speed.
berquqa apricot.
berred, *jberred* to cool; to make cold; (*fig.*) to calm; to pacify; to appease.
berrina gimlet.
berritta a cap.
berrittin biretta.
betbut reed pipe.
bettiħa melon.
bettija barrel; cask.
bewl (vulgari) urine.
bews kissing; kisses.
bewsa a kiss; **tafa' bewsa lil**, to throw a kiss to.
bewwiela a urinal; a latrine; a public convenience.
bexxa (xita) a drizzle; a moderate shower of rain.
bexxaq, *jbexxaq* to open slightly; to leave ajar; not quite closed.
bexxex, *jbexxex* to sprinkle.
bexxiexa a watering can.
beżaq, *jobżoq* to spit.
beżbuża a tuft of hair; a lock of hair.
beżgħan afraid; frightened; fearful; timid; timorous.
beżqa a spit.
beżżel, *jbeżżel* to bring bad luck; **beżżul**, unlucky.
beżżiegħ timid; timorous; fearful; coward.
beżżula a nipple; teat; a woman's breast.
bezzun a roll; a small loaf.
bhejjem (li jirgħu) cattle; **min irabbi l-bhejjem**, cattle-breeder; **marda, mxija fuq il-bhejjem**, cattle-plague.
bhima beast; a brute; **bhima tat-tagħbija**, beast of burden; **ta' bhima**, beastly.
bħal, bħala such; like; the same as; similar to; **bħalha**, like her; **bħalu**, like him; **bħal dak**, like that; **hi bħal din**, it is like this; **raġel bħal dan**, such a man; **bħal xejn**, perhaps; **bħal-lum ġimgħa**, to-day week.
bħal kieku as; as if; it appears that.
bi (*a.* 'b'').
Bibbja Bible.
bibljoteka library.
biċċa bit; piece; **biċċa ħobż**, a piece of bread; **biċċa karta**, a piece of paper; **biċċa minn din**, a bit of this; **il-biċċa l-kbira**, the greater part; **biċċa tal-familja**, a family matter; a family affair; **biċċa bluha**, a piece

of buffoonery; **biċċa maqtugħa minn xi ġurnal**, a press cutting.

biċ-ċajt jokingly; in jest; for fun.

biċ-ċar clearly; plainly; evidently.

biċċerija slaughter-house; abattoir.

biċċier butcher.

biċċiet pieces; bits; **kisser f'biċċiet**, to break to pieces.

bid-daqna bearded.

biddel, *jbiddel* to change; to alter; to make different; to vary.

bidel, *jibdel* to exchange; to change; to barter.

bid-dnewwa by force; compulsory; **bis-sewwa jew bid-dnewwa**, by hook or by crook.

bidla a change; an alteration; a modification; a mutation; an exchange; **bidla ta' ħwejjeġ**, a change of clothes.

bidu start; beginning; commencement; **mill-bidu sa l-aħħar**, from beginning to end.

bidwi farmer; husbandman.

bieb door; **fetaħ il-bieb**, to open the door; **għalaq il-bieb**, to shut the door; **sfronda bieb**, to burst a door open; **bieb ma' bieb**, next door to; **ħabbat fuq il-bieb**, to knock at the door; **wera lil xi ħadd il-bieb** (keċ-ċieh), to show one the door; **għalaq il-bieb f'wiċċ xi ħadd**, to shut the door in a person's face; **il-bieb ta' wara**, the back-door.

bieba (tal-ħobż) crumb; soft part of the bread.

biedja farming; husbandry.

biegħ, *jbigħ* to sell; (*fig.*) to betray; to deceive; **biegħ bi rħis**, to sell cheaply; **biegħ bil-għoli**, to sell dear.

biegħed, *jbiegħed* to remove; to send far away; to go far from; to go a longer way.

bieqja a bowl; a cup; a porringer.

biered cold; chilled; frozen; indifferent; slack.

bierek, *jbierek* to bless.

bies, *jbus* to kiss.

biex how; with what; in what way; in order to.

bieżel active; industrious; diligent; quick; hard-working.

biki weeping; crying; shedding of tears; **biki li ma jiswa xejn**, crying over spilt milk.

bikja a cry; a weeping; **infexx f'bikja**, to burst into tears.

bikkem, *jbikkem* to dumbfound; to make one dumb.

bikri early.

bil- with the; with; by; **bil-pjaċir kollu**, with pleasure; **bil-għajnuna tagħkom**, with your help; **bil-lejl**, by night; **bil-baħar u bl-art**, by sea and by land; **bil-permess tiegħek**, by your leave; **bil-ftit il-ftit**, little by little.

bil-fard odd.

bil-fors by force; compulsory.

bil-ġiri soon; at once; quickly; speedily.

bil-ġuħ hungry; **kien bil-ġuħ**, to be hungry.

bil-għaġla in a hurry.

bil-għaks stingily.

bil-għatx thirsty; **kellu l-għatx**, to be thirsty.

bil-herra roughly; snappishly; rudely; bluntly.

bil-ħaqq by the way.

bil-ħeffa quickly; smartly.

bil-ħlewwa sweetly; gently; nicely.

bil-ħniena hardly.

bili bile.

biljard billiards; **bilja, boċċa tal-biljard**, billiard ball.

bil-jedd by right.

biljett ticket; note; visiting-card; **bil-jett tal-valiġġi**, check; ticket.

bil-kemm hardly; scarcely; almost; nearly.

bil-korla angrily; wrathfully.

billi as; owing to; what of it; what matters; never mind.

bil-maqlub inside out; contrary; the reverse.

bil-mixi on foot; walking.
bil-mod slowly.
bil-moħbi secretly; privately; clandestinely.
bil-qatra l-qatra drop by drop; by drops.
bil-qiegħda sitting.
bil-qies to measure; moderately; exactly.
bil-quddiem in advance; **ħallas bil-quddiem**, to pay in advance.
bil-wieqfa standing.
bil-wisq very much; a great many; a good deal.
bin (iben) *tingħaqad mal-partiċelli* **ha, na, kom, hom,** *u tfisser* – son. *Għalhekk* – **binha**, her son; **binna** our son; **binkom**, your son; **binhom**, their son.
bin-ngħas sleepy.
bin-nhar by day; in the day time; **fid-dija ta' bin-nhar**, in broad daylight.
bini building; structure; an edifice.
bint (ara wkoll **bin**) daughter.
bir well.
bired, *jibred* to cool down; to grow cold; (*fig.*) to calm down.
birra beer; **min jagħmel il-birra**, brewer; **fejn issir il-birra**, (**birrerija**), brewery.
biskott biscuit.
biss only; alone; **rajtu darba biss**, I saw him only once; **mhux hu biss**, not only he.
bis-saħħa (ta') to drink to one's health; **bis-saħħa tiegħek**, to your health.
bis-sewwa properly; in the right, proper way; **bis-sewwa jew bid-dnewwa**, by hook or by crook.
bis-sod in earnest; earnestly; seriously.
biswit opposite.
bitħa court-yard.
bittija barrel.
bixkilla basket; wicker-basket.
bixra (ħarsa, mġiba) air; mien, look.
bix-xaba' abundantly.
biżestili (sena) leap year.
biża' fear; terror; dread; **kellu biża' minn xi ħadd**, to fear someone; **żamm fil-biża'**, to keep in fear; **renju tal-biża'**, a reign of terror.
biżżejjed enough; sufficiently; **biżżejjed wieħed**, one is enough.
bjad, *jibjad* (sar abjad) to become white; to grow white.
bjond blonde.
bjuda whiteness.
bjuger bugle.
bla (mingħajr) without; **bla ma tkellem**, without speaking; **bla telf ta' żmien**, without delay.
bla fidi unbelieving; without faith; incredulous.
bla ġieh without character; no good.
bla grazzja awkward; ungraceful; rough.
bla għajnuna alone; without any help; without any assistance.
bla ħila coward.
bla ħsieb unexpectedly; by chance.
bla ikel without any food.
bla ilma (xott) without water; dry; drained; waterless.
blakk blacking (paste); shoe polish.
bla kont careless; negligent; indifferent.
bla kuraġġ (ara **bla ħila**).
bl-amment by heart; **tgħallem bl-amment**, to learn by heart.
bla moħħ brainless; crack-brained; crazy; silly; simpleton.
bla nifs breathless; out of breath.
blanzun bud.
bla ponta blunt.
bla qalb heartless; cruel.
bla qerq open; frank; candid; honest; straightforward.
bla qies excessive; immoderate; excessively; immoderately; exhorbitantly.
bla ras ignorant; dull; weak-headed; brainless.
bla riħ (bnazzi) calm; serene.

bla sens without sense; witless; senseless.
bla sħab cloudless; serene; clear.
bla snien toothless.
blat rocks.
blata a rock; a large stone; **blata ta' qabar**, tomb-stone; grave-stone.
bla tfal childless.
bla xifer blunt.
bl-imgħawweġ unfairly; unjustly; dishonestly; crookedly.
bluha foolishness; stupidity; silliness.
bluża blouse.
bnazzi fine weather; calm.
bniedem, bniedma a man; a woman; a person; **bnedmin**, men; women; persons; people; human beings.
bniet daughters.
boċċa a marble; a bowl; **boċċa ta' l-għajn**, eye-ball; **logħob tal-boċċi**, bowls, bowling.
bodbod he-goat.
bogħod far; far away; distant; afar; a long way off; **mill-bogħod**, from afar; **'il bogħod ferm**, very far; **darba fil-bogħod**, rarely; seldom; **bogħod mill-għajn, bogħod mill-qalb**, out of sight, out of mind.
bojja hangman; executioner.
bojod white.
bokka hole; entrance.
bokkaport hatchway.
bokkin cigarette-holder.
bokkla buckle; clasp.
bokra (minn **bakkar**) early; early rising; **il-bokra ssewwi ż-żokra**, it's the early bird that catches the worm.
bolla stamp; seal; postage stamp.
bolla (editt tal-Papa) bull; a Pope's letter.
bomba a bomb; **tfigħ ta' bombi**, bombardment.
bomblu pitcher; water-cooler.
bonasira good evening.
boqqa a draught; a mouthful.
boqxiex spoke shave; (*fig.*) money.
borġ heap; lot.
borma pot.
borra snow.
borża bag; handbag; **borża tal-karti**, paper-bag.
bosk a wood.
bosta much; many; a great many.
boton a brood.
bott a tin.
boxxla compass.
bozza (tad-dawl elettriku) an electric bulb.
bqija change; remainder.
brama jellyfish.
branda hammock.
bravu clever; skilful; good.
brazz (ta' siġġu) arm of a chair.
brazz (tax-xama') sconce; candlestick.
brazzuletta bracelet.
briġġ (pont ta' bastiment) bridge.
brigant bandit; robber; brigand; highwayman.
brigata brigade; company.
brija dandruff.
brikkun rascal; knave; scoundrel.
brilja bridle.
brillant (ħaġra prezzjuża) brilliant.
brilli skittles.
brimba spider.
brinġiela aubergine; egg-plant.
brix scraping; scratching.
brodu broth; soup.
brokkli sprouts.
bronkite bronchitis.
bronż bronze.
bronżina bearing; ball-bearing.
broxk scrubbing brush.
bruda chilliness; coldness; coolness; indifference.
btala holiday.
buffun a buffoon; a jester.
buffura a squall.
buflu bufalo.
bugħaddas diver.
bugħarwien slug; snail.
bugħawwieġ cramp.
bukkaport trap door; hatchway.
bukkett a bunch; **bukkett fjuri**, a bunch of flowers.

bukkun a mouthful; a bit.
buli bad humour; bad mood; ill temper; sulkiness.
buljut boiled meat.
bullettin bulletin.
bumbardament bombardment.
bumerin seal.
buqar jug.
burdell brothel.
burdnar carrier; transport-worker.
burdura border; edge; hem.
buri humour; temper; mood; **kien bil-buri tajba**, to be in good mood; **qam bil-buri**, to be out of humour.
burraxka a squall; a storm; a violent storm; a gale; a tempest.
busbież fennel.
buskett a grove; a small wood.
bust bust; chest.
but pocket.
butir butter; **sikkina tal-butir**, butter-knife; **dellek il-butir**, to butter; **butiriera**, butter-dish.
buttar cooper.
buttun (ta' rota) a hub; wheel-hub.
buttuna button; **waħħal buttuna**, to sew on a button.
butwila tall; of high stature.
bux boxwood.
bużillis difficulty; obstacle; **dan hu l-bużillis**, this is the obstacle.
bużnanna great-grandmother; **bużnannu**, great-grandfather.
bużżieqa a balloon; a bladder; (*għal bniedem*) surly; unfriendly; **bużżieqa ta' l-ilma**, a bubble.
bxara news.
bxima (sekonda) after-birth.
bżar pepper; **bżar aħdar**, green pepper; **bżar aħmar**, red pepper.
bżieq spit; spittle.
bżonn need.
bżulija diligence; haste; speed; activity.